Your Free Build Guide

Build a Vendor Contract *Risk Checker*

The full plan, the exact prompts, and the scoring logic to build a tool that reads any vendor contract and tells you where the risks are. You can build it in about 15 minutes with Claude Code. No legal team. No coding.

WHY I BUILT THIS

Never get burned by a *vendor contract* again

Last month I ran a performance review for a lead generation agency I had hired to book demos for my sales team. They missed the target. So I thought of putting some penalty on them, and I pulled up the contract to check. There was nothing there. No penalty for missing goals. They still got paid for their time. And if I wanted to walk away, I had to give them a month's notice.

I felt cheated. But then I realized it was my own mistake. I should have read that contract properly before I signed it. So I built a tool that does exactly that, and this guide shows you how to build your own.

> **This is not legal advice.** It is a simple fairness check from the buyer's side. Does this contract actually protect the person signing it? Use it to catch the risks, so you walk into the negotiation prepared.

WHAT YOU'LL BUILD

1 · THE SCORECARD

Five checks, 20 points each. One score out of 100, and a clear risk level you can read in a second.

2 · THE THREE QUESTIONS

A 30 second context step that fits the read to your vendor, your stakes, and your stage.

3 · THE REPORT

The red flags, what to watch out for, and what looks good. Each one with what to actually say to the vendor.

4 · THE NEGOTIATION LIST

Your top three things to fix before you sign. This is the whole point.

Five checks, *one hundred points*

The tool reads the contract and scores it on the five things that decide whether a vendor deal is fair. Each one is worth 20 points. Add them up and you get a single score. And because a weak contract loses points, **a lower score means higher risk.**

1 **Deliverable Clarity**
Are the deliverables specific and measurable, or just a vague scope?

2 **Performance Accountability**
If they do not deliver, is there any penalty or consequence?

3 **Data Ownership**
Who owns the data that gets created during the engagement?

4 **Exit Terms**
Can you walk away, or are you locked in?

5 **Payment vs. Delivery Alignment**
Are you paying for results, or just for their time?

RISK BANDS. LOWER SCORE, HIGHER RISK.

Low	Moderate	High	Critical
80 to 100	60 to 79	40 to 59	0 to 39

THE THREE QUESTIONS IT ASKS FIRST

1. **What kind of vendor is this?** Lead or demand gen, performance marketing, PR or content, other.
2. **What is most at stake?** Qualified pipeline, budget and cash flow, or a clean exit.
3. **Where are you in the process?** Reviewing before signing, already signed, or renewing.

THE RULES BEHIND EACH SCORE

What each check *rewards and penalizes*

This is the logic the tool uses. Green flags earn points. Red flags lose them. Put these conditions into your prompt, so the scoring is clear and repeatable, and not a black box.

CHECK	EARNS POINTS	LOSES POINTS
Deliverable Clarity	GREEN FLAGS A clear definition of a "qualified" deliverable, a named sign-off authority, measurable targets.	RED FLAGS Vague scope, "subject to market conditions", no acceptance criteria.
Performance Accountability	GREEN FLAGS Fixed targets, a penalty or make-good for shortfalls, a remediation period.	RED FLAGS "Not a guarantee", no penalty, paid in full whatever the outcome.
Data Ownership	GREEN FLAGS You own the contacts, engagement history and reports, with a clear return on exit.	RED FLAGS The vendor keeps the data, return depends on payment, no data protection terms.
Exit Terms	GREEN FLAGS Reasonable notice, the right to exit if targets are missed, a pro-rata refund.	RED FLAGS Lock-in, no refund of advance, "targets exhausted" decided by the vendor alone.
Payment vs. Delivery	GREEN FLAGS Milestones or holdbacks, paying in arrears, payment tied to proof of work.	RED FLAGS 100% advance, no refund, fee or tax (like GST) that does not add up.

How the report reads. For every check the tool shows three buckets. Red Flags, What to Watch Out For, and What Looks Good. And for each finding it gives you three lines. What the contract says, why it matters, and what to propose to the vendor.

Plan it, then *build it*

Setup, once. You need the Claude desktop app on at least the $20 plan. Using Codex? The same prompts work there. There is no terminal, and no folder to set up. We are just making one HTML file that opens in your browser. I use **Opus** for the plan, then switch to **Sonnet** to build, because it is faster and lighter on tokens.

PROMPT 1 · PLAN (OPUS) — Paste into Claude Code

```
I want to build a Vendor Contract Assessment tool as a single, self-contained HTML file (all CSS and JavaScript inline, no backend, no API keys, no build step). Before writing any code, plan it out for me.

It scores a pasted contract out of 100 across exactly these 5 categories, 20 points each: (1) Deliverable Clarity, (2) Performance Accountability, (3) Data Ownership, (4) Exit Terms, (5) Payment vs. Delivery Alignment.

Design a transparent, rule-based scoring engine (no LLM calls). For each category propose about 4 checks, the clause patterns or keywords to look for, the points each is worth (adding up to 20), and whether it adds or subtracts. Also define: the 3 context questions to ask first (vendor type, what is at stake, stage in the process); the risk bands where a LOWER score is HIGHER risk (80 to 100 Low, 60 to 79 Moderate, 40 to 59 High, 0 to 39 Critical); and the report structure (per category: Red Flags, What to Watch Out For, What Looks Good, each with what the contract says, why it matters, what to propose) ending in a "Top 3 Priorities Before You Sign" list. Give me the plan first. Do not write the app yet.
```

PROMPT 2 · BUILD (SONNET) — Paste into Claude Code

```
The plan looks good. Build it as one file called vendor-contract-assessor.html, everything inline, opens directly in a browser, no build step.

Flow: a header; a large text box to paste the contract, with a "Continue" button; the 3 questions we planned; then an "Assess Contract" button. On assess, run the rule-based engine and show a dashboard: a horizontal bar per category (0 to 20) colour-coded by strength, plus a large total out of 100 and the overall risk level with a matching colour. Warm off-white background, restrained type, good spacing. On-screen only, no PDF or download.
```

The report, the *run, the extras*

PROMPT 3 · THE REPORT (SONNET)

Paste into Claude Code

```
Now build the detailed report below the dashboard. For each of the 5 categories, add a section with
three labelled buckets: Red Flags, What to Watch Out For, and What Looks Good. For every finding show
three short lines: what the contract says, why it matters, and what to propose to the vendor. At the
very bottom, add a highlighted box called "Top 3 Priorities Before You Sign" that pulls the three
highest-impact issues from across all categories into a prioritised list. Keep it all on-screen and
easy to scan.
```

PROMPT 4 · RUN & VERIFY (SONNET)

Paste into Claude Code

```
Let's test it on a real contract. Open vendor-contract-assessor.html in the preview and run a self-
check using the agreement I'm pasting below. Walk through pasting it, answering the 3 questions as the
buyer, and assessing it. Show me the category scores, the total, and the top 3 priorities. If any
score or finding looks wrong or unfair, tell me why and fix the logic.

[ paste the contract text here ]
```

PROMPT 5 · OPTIONAL EXTRAS

Paste into Claude Code

```
Two optional upgrades: (1) let me upload a .pdf or .docx and pull the text into the browser instead of
pasting, and (2) add a "Load sample contract" button so anyone can try the tool in one click. Keep it
a single file if you can; if a library is needed, load it from a CDN.
```

IT WORKS · A REAL EXAMPLE

One real contract: *41 out of 100*

Here is the tool run on a real marketing agreement, checked from the buyer's side. Two of the five checks fail badly. And that is exactly where the negotiation starts.

41/100

Overall verdict: **High Risk.** This contract is written to protect the vendor, not the buyer. You can still work with it, but only after three fixes.

Deliverable Clarity	12 / 20
Performance Accountability	4 / 20
Data Ownership	12 / 20
Exit Terms	8 / 20
Payment vs. Delivery Alignment	5 / 20

TOP 3 PRIORITIES BEFORE YOU SIGN

1. **Put accountability in writing.** The vendor promises 12 to 15 meetings, but the contract calls them "not a guarantee", with no penalty. Ask for a minimum meetings SLA, with a make-good month or a partial credit if they fall short.

2. **Do not pay everything upfront for work that is not guaranteed.** Move to monthly in arrears, or milestones, or add a pro-rata refund if you exit early. And fix the GST contradiction (one place says plus 18%, another says inclusive).

3. **Close the data and exit gaps.** Add a data protection clause with breach notification and a deletion certificate. Drop the "data returned only after dues are paid" condition. And fix the 5 day versus 7 day termination notice.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Build it, or *skip the build*

You now have the plan, the exact prompts, and the scoring logic. Build your own in about 15 minutes. Or use the hosted, AI-powered version, and put your energy into the negotiation instead of the wiring.

The *Workbench*

Practical tools for founders and CMOs who have no legal team and no time to spare. I build them in the open, then hand you the prompts.

Want this without building it? Try the hosted vendor contract tool, or book a CMO consult.

Try the hosted tool

jaydipsikdar.com/resources/vendor-check

MORE FREE TOOLS

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Contract check, CMO kit and more

WATCH THE BUILD

The Workbench on YouTube

Tools built live, start to finish

THE NEWSLETTER

One build, one lesson, one insight

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